hours a day. This network doesn't need to hire and train millions of human agents to follow us around; it relies on digital agents instead. And the network doesn't even need to pay for these digital agents. Citizens pay for the agents on our own initiative, and we carry them with us wherever we go.

The agent monitoring Iosifescu didn't accompany Iosifescu into the toilet and didn't sit beside the bed while Iosifescu was having sex. Today, our smartphone sometimes does exactly that. Moreover, many of the activities Iosifescu did without any help from his computer – like reading the news, chatting with friends or buying food – are now done online, so it is even easier for the network to know what we are doing and saying. We ourselves are the informers that provide the network with our raw data. Even those without smartphones are almost always within the orbit of some camera, microphone, or tracking device, and they too constantly interact with the computer network in order to find work, buy a train ticket, get a medical prescription or simply walk down the street. The computer network has become the nexus of most human activities. In the middle of almost every financial, social or political transaction, we now find a computer. Consequently, like Adam and Eve in paradise, we cannot hide from the eye in the clouds.

Just as the computer network doesn't need millions of human agents to follow us, it also doesn't need millions of human analysts to make sense of our data. The ocean of paper in Securitate headquarters never analyzed itself. But thanks to the magic of machine learning and AI, computers can themselves analyze most of the information they accumulate. An average human can read about 250 words per minute.[8] A Securitate analyst working twelve-hour shifts without taking any days off, could read about 2.6 billion words during a forty-year career. In 2024 language algorithms like ChatGPT and Meta's Llama can process millions of words per minute and 'read' 2.6 billion words in a couple of hours.[9] The ability of such algorithms to process images, audio recordings and video footage is equally superhuman.

Even more important, the algorithms far surpass humans in their ability to spot patterns in that ocean of data. Identifying patterns requires both the ability to create ideas and the ability to make decisions. For example, how do human analysts identify someone as a 'suspected terrorist' who merits closer attention? First, they *create* a set of general criteria, such as 'reading